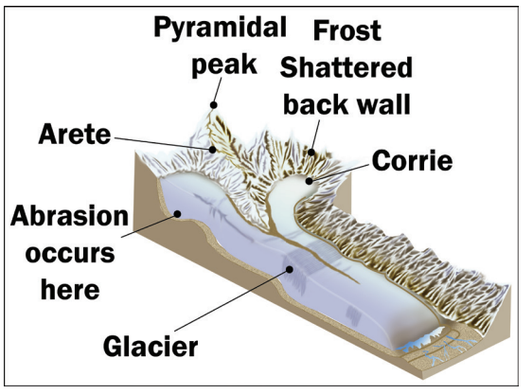


Figure 4.18 Glaciated features

5. Horn

If the summit of the Arete is roughly inclined, it gives rise to pyramidal peaks which are known as horns. Example, Matterhorn of Alps-Switzerland.

6. Nunataks

A rock mass surrounded by ice is called Nunatak. It stands out as an island in the ice.

7. Fjord

The fjord is formed as a steep-sided narrow entrance like feature at the coast of a glaciated region where the stream meets the coast. Fjords are common in Norway, Greenland and Newzealand.

4.7.5 Depositional landforms of glaciers

When the glaciers melt or recede they deposit the rock material, brought by them, forming hillocks of various shapes and sizes. The depositional landforms of the glaciers are;

1. Moraines

Moraines are the piles of dirt and rock that are deposited by a glacier as it moves across the landscape. These debris fields exist in places where glaciers have moved through in the past. There are many kinds of glacial moraines that form. Moraines are generally classified based on their location.

a) Lateral Moraines

Lateral moraines are ridges of debris that run parallel to the sides of a glacier. This is often accompanied by scraping of the valley sides which means the debris from the moraine creates high ridges above the glacier.

b) Ground Moraines

Ground moraines are glacial depositions formed on the floor of glacial valley. Ground moraines can be deposited in between lateral moraines in the case of many alpine glaciers.

c) Medial Moraines

Medial moraines are ridges of debris that are left down a valley floor at the middle of two glaciers. Both glaciers merge together and their debris combine to form a consistent moraine field along their borders. They are actually the merging of two lateral moraines which continue as medial moraines.

d) Terminal or End Moraines

Terminal or end moraines are left by the end of a glacier. The slower a glacier moves the bigger the moraine will be as the glacier has more time to accumulate outside debris.

e) Recessional Moraines

This recessional moraine runs across the landscape behind a terminal moraine. They are caused by times when the glacier slows or stops in its movement. It is formed because the receding glacier pauses in certain places for a long time before continuing its movement.

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